From campaign spend to sales conversations

A practical review of what marketing brings in, where leads fall out of the funnel, and how to choose the next lead to contact.

Recorded spend	Leads	Sales-accepted	Won deals	Booked revenue
$760,209	**7,200**	**1,602**	**553**	**$8,768,402**

The central finding

Lead volume is only the opening number. Across the sample, 7,200 leads became 3,002 marketing-qualified leads, 1,602 sales-accepted leads and 553 wins. Recorded booked revenue is $8,768,402 against $760,209 of program spend. That works out to 11.53x booked revenue per recorded marketing dollar, but it is not profit and does not include every cost of selling or serving a customer.

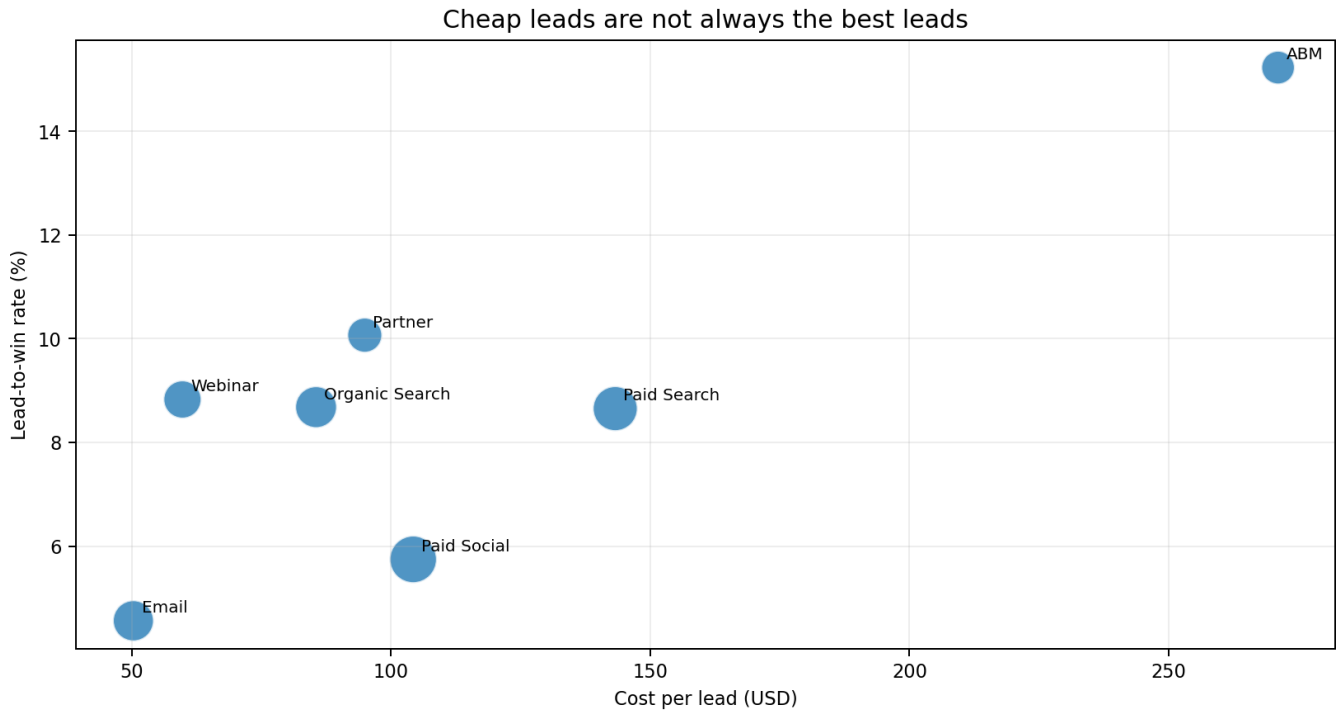
Partner has the highest observed revenue-to-spend ratio. Paid Search brings in the most booked revenue in absolute dollars. Those are different questions, and both belong in a budget review.

What this report covers

The work combines campaign economics, funnel losses, a chronological lead-score test, and a comparison of first-touch, last-touch and linear attribution. All records are synthetic and exist to demonstrate the workflow; none should be read as the performance of a real company.

1. Campaign economics

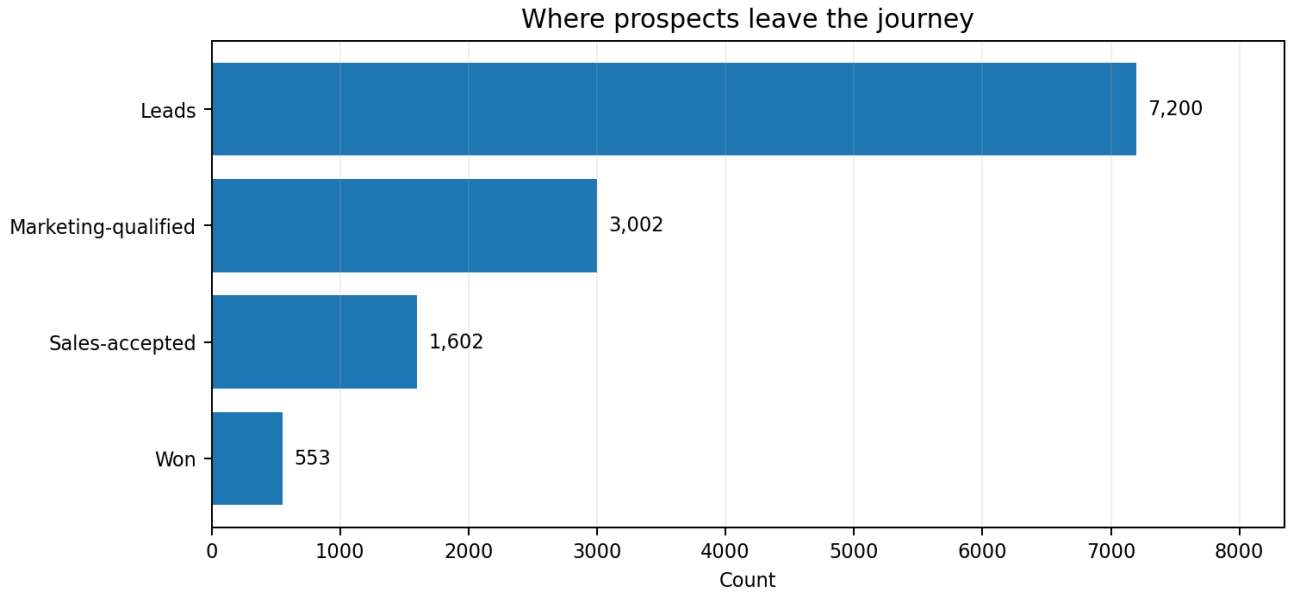
Cost per lead is helpful for spotting expensive acquisition. It is not enough to decide where budget belongs. A low-cost channel can still struggle to create sales-ready demand, while a costly channel may earn its place if its leads progress and close at a higher rate.

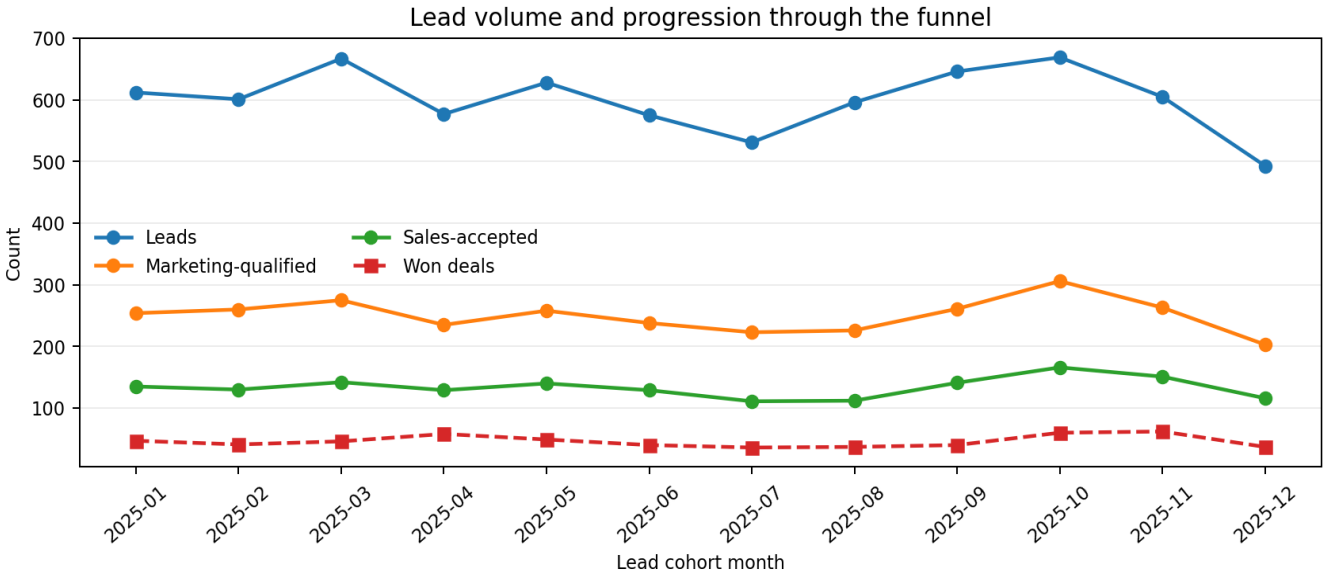


Channel	Spend	Leads	Cost / lead	Wins	Cost / win	Revenue / spend
Partner	$41,495	437	$95	44	$943	21.80x
Webinar	$41,319	691	$60	61	$677	20.78x
ABM	$94,334	348	$271	53	$1,780	14.48x
Organic Search	$94,634	1,106	$86	96	$986	13.35x
Email	$50,787	1,009	$50	46	$1,104	11.65x
Paid Search	$225,195	1,572	$143	136	$1,656	9.60x
Paid Social	$212,445	2,037	$104	117	$1,816	7.64x

The weakest observed ratio belongs to Paid Social at 7.64x. This is a review cue rather than an automatic cut: check audience overlap, assisted conversions, sales capacity and what would happen if that channel disappeared before making a change.

2. Where the funnel thins out

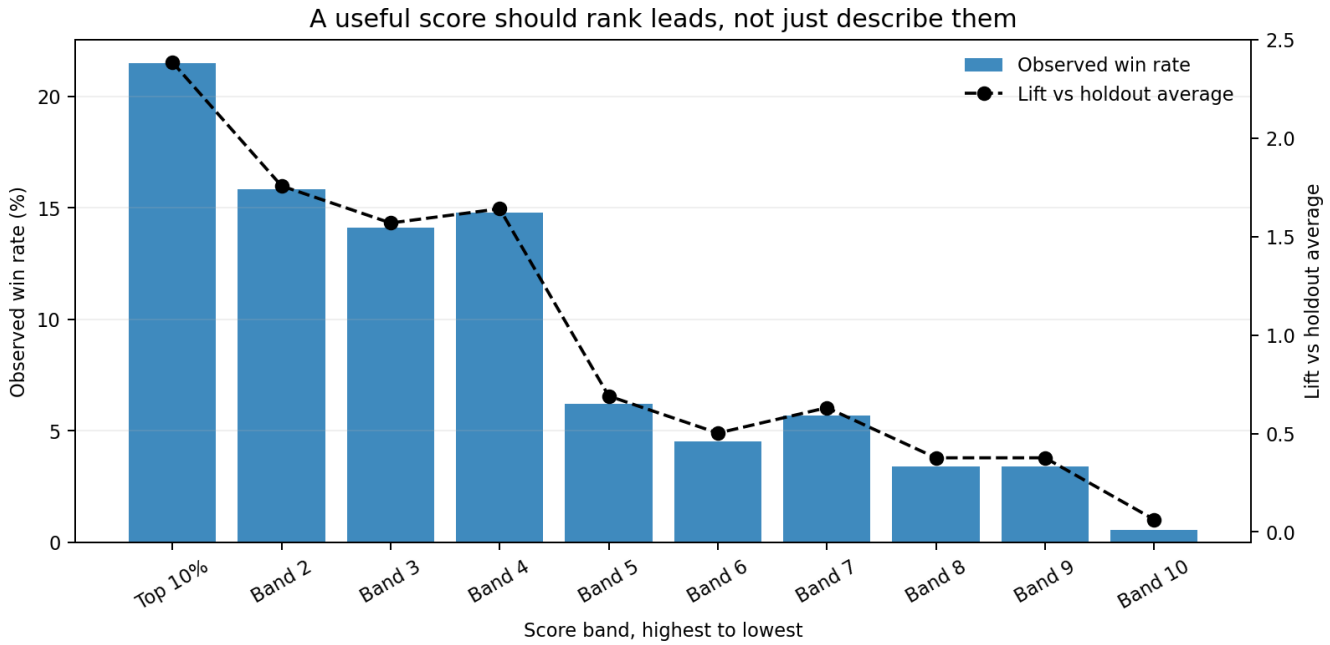




The funnel stages are nested: every sales-accepted lead was marketing-qualified, and every win was sales-accepted. The largest raw drop is from initial lead to marketing qualification, but the most useful operating question is which campaigns deliver people who sales accepts and eventually closes. A follow-up SLA on clear intent signals is easier to act on than a vague request to generate more leads.

3. A lead score sales can question

The baseline score uses a logistic regression trained on January through September, then tests its rankings on October through December. It uses channel, campaign, account size, seniority, region, business email, recent site activity, pricing visits, content activity, webinar attendance and demo requests. It does not use the sales outcome, deal value or revenue as inputs.

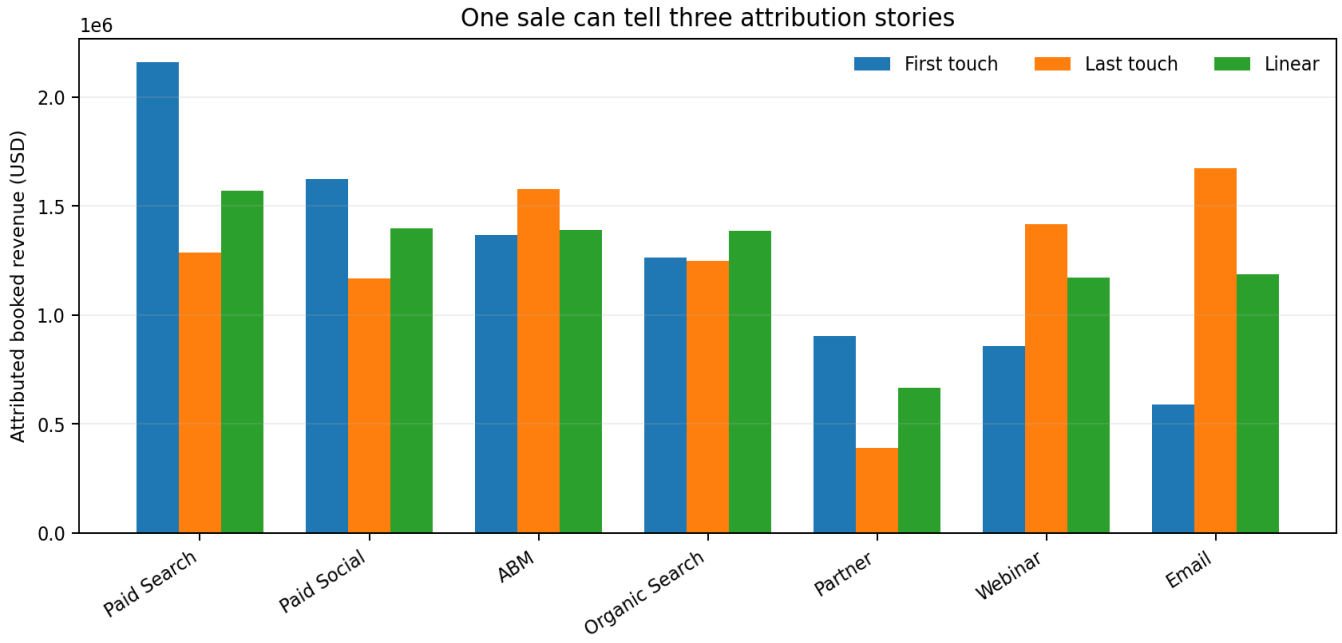


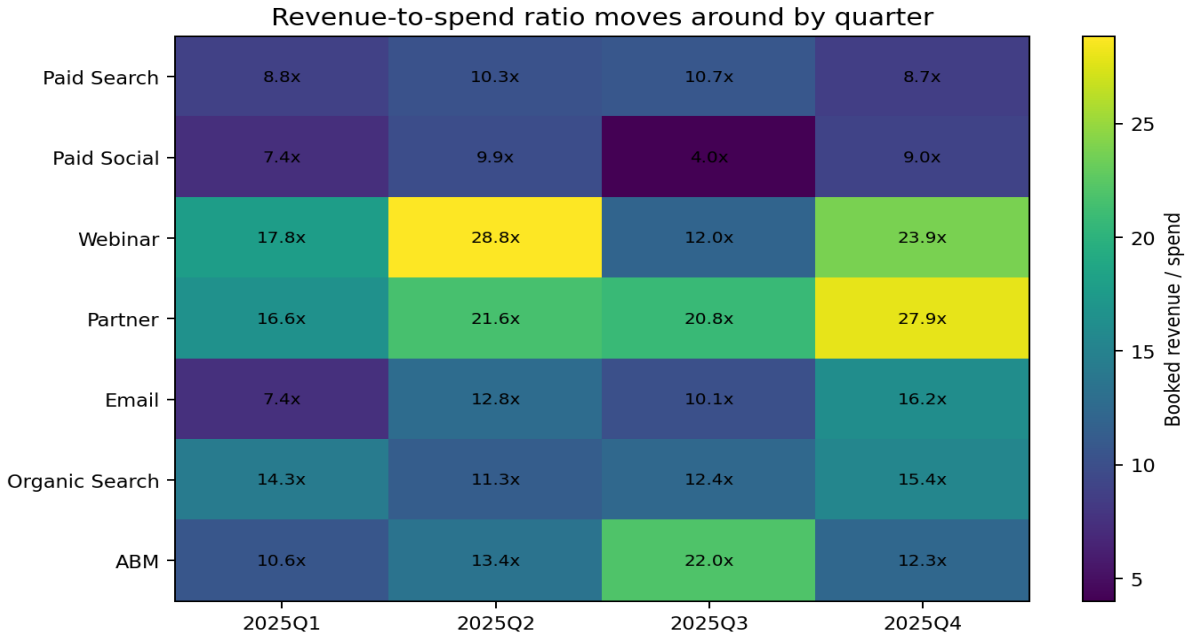
Test measure	Result
Holdout period	2025-10-01 to 2025-12-31
Holdout leads	1,767
ROC AUC	0.717
Average precision	0.176
Brier score	0.0792
Win rate in top score decile	21.5%
Win rate across holdout	9.0%
Top-decile lift	2.39x

The point of the score is to order the queue, not to replace a sales rep's judgment. Each record carries a short list of visible signals and a suggested next step. The reported metrics come from the held-out quarter; the full scored CSV also contains historical scores for exploration, and those earlier scores are not a fair out-of-time test.

4. Attribution changes the story

A first-touch report asks which campaign introduced the lead. A last-touch report asks which channel appeared last before the recorded path ended. Linear attribution shares credit among unique channels touched. Each view answers a different bookkeeping question; none proves that a channel caused the sale.





Across all channels, about $1,855,552 of booked-revenue credit moves from one channel bucket to another when the report changes from first-touch to last-touch. That is 21.2% of booked revenue. It is attribution disagreement, not money gained or lost.

The quarterly heatmap is included to show how quickly a strong-looking ratio can move when a small channel has only a handful of wins. Read it with volume and spend, not in isolation.

5. What to do next

Start with a measured sales handoff. Demo requests and repeat pricing visits are the clearest immediate signals in this sample, so route them quickly and measure whether a faster response improves acceptance and win rate.

Use three campaign measures together: cost per sales-accepted lead, cost per win, and booked revenue per recorded marketing dollar. Keep cost per lead as an acquisition diagnostic, not the main verdict.

A simple budget exercise would move $21,244 from Paid Social to Partner. Under historical average rates, that would suggest +20.0 net leads and +300,821 net booked revenue. That is a mechanical scenario, not a forecast: it assumes no saturation, no auction movement, no audience overlap and no sales-capacity limit. A small test is the sensible next step.

Before applying this to a real business

Replace the demo data with consented CRM and campaign records, define a common lead identity, deduplicate people and accounts, align the spend and sales windows, and add gross margin or contribution profit. Keep a holdout period for score testing. For budget changes, use a control group or incrementality test where possible.

Method and limitations

The dataset is synthetic. Cost and delivery numbers are generated. Revenue is booked deal value, not contribution margin. Paid impressions and clicks are included only for Paid Search and Paid Social because other channels do not share the same exposure denominator. The score is a simple baseline, the holdout is one quarter, and the touchpoint paths are simulated. All channel and attribution findings are descriptive; no causal claim is made.

Files to explore

The companion project includes raw lead and touchpoint files, campaign spend records, scored leads, model metrics, campaign and channel rollups, attribution tables, SQL examples, Python scripts, chart files, and an interactive dashboard. Use README.md for the run instructions.